MIL-B-43515A(GL)
22 March 1977
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43515(GL)
30 June 1967

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BELT, MAN'S, WAIST, BLUE 334 (ARMY BAND UNIFORM)

This specification is approved for use by the Natick Research and Development Command, Department of the Army and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

* 1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for an ornamented, cotton webbing belt.

* 1.2 Classification. The belt shall be of one type and in the following lengths (see 6.2).

Short
Long

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton
DDD-L-20 - Label: For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use)

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Command, Natick, MA 01760, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8405

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PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing

MILITARY

MIL-W-530 - Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors
MIL-B-13466 - Braid, Textile and Lace, Vellum, Woven, Textile (for Blue Dress Uniform)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Guide samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from the specification may appear in the sample, in which case the specification shall govern.

* 3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.4).

3.3 Materials.

3.3.1 Webbing, cotton. The basic material for the belt shall be cotton webbing, 1-3/4 inches (45 mm) wide conforming to type V, class 3 of MIL-W-530. The color shall be Blue 334.

* 3.3.1.1 Colorfastness. The dyed webbing shall show colorfastness to crocking and laundering as specified in MIL-W-530 and in addition shall show colorfastness to light and perspiration equal to or better than the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1. When no standard sample is available, the webbing shall show good fastness to light and perspiration when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.3.2 Braid. The braid for the belt ornamentation shall conform to type I, class 4, color Goldenlite, Cable No. 17425 of MIL-B-13466.

* 3.3.3 Thread. The cotton thread used for seaming and stitching shall be type IC2, ticket number A, Goldenlite AJ, C.A. 66051, conforming to V-T-276.

* 3.3.4 Marking. The size, stock number (when applicable), contract number, and name of the contractor shall be applied to the inside of the belt, centered toward the end of the belt. The size of the characters shall be a minimum 18 point, approximately 1/4 inch (6 mm) and shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. The label shall show fastness to laundering.

* 3.3.5 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.2.1 shall be removed from production and replaced with nondefective and properly matched components.

3.4 Design. The belt shall be made from a strip of webbing ornamented with two stripes of braid - one stripe flush with the top edge of the belt and one stripe flush with the bottom edge of the belt. The braids shall be double stitched to each edge. The finished belt shall be equipped with two belt keepers. One belt keeper shall be placed at each end of the belt to secure the belt buckle and buckle catch. Keepers shall be of the same braid as the ornamentation but shall be double thickness to fit snugly over the belt ends.

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3.5 Construction.

* 3.5.1 Stitching. Ends of all stitching, except when caught in other seams or stitching, shall be backstitched or overstitched 1/2 inch (13 mm) minimum. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread, or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be embeddded in the materials sewn.

* 3.5.1.1 Repairs of stitching. Repairs of stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during sewing, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1/2 inch (13 mm) back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks, or two or more consecutive skipped or runoff stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1/2 inch (13 mm) in back of the defective area, continue over the defective area, and continue a minimum of 1/2 inch (13 mm) beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

* 3.5.2 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/4 inch (6 mm).

* 3.5.3 Webbing. The webbing for the belts shall be cut to the required length as follows:

Short - 42 ± 1/2 inches (1067 ± 13 mm)
Long - 51 ± 1/2 inches (1295 ± 13 mm)

* 3.5.4 Ornamentation. A strip of the braid shall be positioned along the length of the belt so that the top edge of the braid is flush within 1/16 inch (1.5 mm) of the top edge of the belt. The braid shall be stitched onto the belt at the top edge of the braid and at the bottom edge of the braid, not more than 1/16 inch (1.5 mm) from edges of braid. At the ends of the belt, the braid shall be turned under approximately 1/2 inch (13 mm). A strip of braid shall also be stitched to the bottom edge of the felt the same as specified above.

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* 3.5.5 Belt keepers. Each keeper shall consist of a strip of braid cut 10 ± 1/8 inches (254 ± 3 mm) long. The strip shall be folded on itself and the side edges stitched not more than 1/16 inch (1.5 mm) from edge. Ends of strip shall be superimposed on each other and stitched 1/2 ± 1/16 inch (13 ± 1.5 mm) from end across the width of the braid. Fold ends back at the seam and stitch each end 1/8 ± 1/16 inch (3 ± 1.5 mm) each side of seam through the keeper. Turn keeper inside out, with ends to inside of the keeper, and thread one keeper over each end of belt. Do not stitch keepers to belt.

3.6 Workmanship. The finished belt shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3)
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4)

* 4.3 First article. When required (see 6.2), the preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be inspected as specified in 4.4.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship, dimensional, and assembly requirements.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document. In addition, the webbing specified in 3.3.1 shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

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* 4.4.1.1 Webbing testing. The webbing shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table I. The test methods listed in table I shall be in accordance with FED-STD-191, wherever applicable. Testing for all requirements listed in table I shall be applicable to the sample unit. The sample unit for all required tests shall be 1/2 linear yard (450 mm). The sample size for each characteristic shall be as follows:

Lot size (yards)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

The lot shall be unacceptable.if one or more units fail to meet any requirement specified.

TABLE I. Material tests

Material	Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method
Webbing	Colorfastness to:		
	Light	3.3.1.1	5660
	Perspiration	3.3.1.1	5680

* 4.4.2 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined in accordance with 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be as specified in 4.4.2.3. The sample unit shall be one fabricated belt with two keepers. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one belt.

* 4.4.2.1 Visual examination of belt. Defects found during visual examination shall be classified in accordance with the list below.

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Webbing	Any hole, cut or tear	X	
	Not firmly or tightly woven	X	
	Edges frayed or scalloped	X	
	Abrasion mark affecting appearance or serviceability	X	
Braid	Any hole, cut or tear	X	
	Unevenly braided	X	
	Braiding loose or tight 1/		X
	Abrasion mark affecting appearance	X	
Color	Not as specified	X	
	Appearance affected by shading or dye streaks 1/	X	
Cleanliness	Spot, stain, or streak clearly noticeable	X	
	Small spots or dirt marks:		
	- seriously affecting appearance	X	
	- affecting appearance but not seriously		X
	Thread ends not trimmed as specified		X
Construction and workmanship	Any component part or required operation omitted	X	
	Any component or workmanship damage	X	
	Spliced, i.e., webbing not one continuous piece	X	
Seams and stitches	One or more broken stitches, or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches	X	
	Stitching irregular		X
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in loose bobbin or top thread		X
	Excessively tight, resulting in puckering of material		X
Design	Not as specified	X	
Marking	Missing, incomplete, incorrect, not legible, or not as specified		X

1/ Clearly visible at normal inspection distance of approximately 3 feet (1 m).

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4.4.2.2 Dimensional examination.

Examine	Defect
Overall length of finished belt (cut length)	Under or over length specified by more than 1/2 inch (13 mm).

4.4.2.3 Inspection level and AQLs. The inspection levels and AQLs, expressed in defects per hundred units, shall be as follows:

Examination	Inspection level	AQL
4.4.2.1	II	2.5 Major 6.5 Total
4.4.2.2	S-3	2.5 One class

* 4.4.3 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that the preservation-packaging, packing and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be closed. Examination of closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per 100 units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number per container is more or less than required

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation-packaging shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

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* 5.1.1 Level A. Ten belts of one size only, shall be coiled together and preserved-packaged in a snug-fitting box conforming to variety 1, style III, type G, class i of PPP-B-566 or type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Box closure shall be secured with 2-inch (51 mm) minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45, applied at the center of the length opening and extending along the bottom and up each side at least 1-1/2 inches (38 mm) of the depth of the box.

* 5.1.2 Commercial packaging. Belts shall be preserved-packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the contractor to the first receiving activity. The package and quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the contractor for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. One hundred and twenty belts of one size only, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.3. Toward the end of the contract, or when there is less than the required amount per shipping container of the same size, mixed sizes may be packed within the same shipping container.

* 5.2.2 Level B packing. One hundred and twenty belts of one size only, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.3. Toward the end of the contract or when there is less than the required amount per shipping container of the same size, mixed sizes may be packed within the same shipping container.

* 5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.3.

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* 5.2.3 Commercial packing. Belts, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by contractors for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Labels, mixed sizes. Each shipping container packed with mixed sizes shall have securely attached at the end and sides, directly under the printing or stenciling, a white paper label 5 by 5 inches (127 by 127 mm) with the words "MIXED SIZES" plainly stamped or printed thereon and under these words shall be legibly printed the correct quantity and sizes contained therein.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The belts are intended for wear by enlisted men of the Department of the Army as a component of the army band uniform.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Length required (see 1.2).
(c) When a first article sample is required (see 3.2, 4.3, and 6.4).
(d) Selection of applicable level of preservation-packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

* 6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first

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* 6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-B-43515A(GL) Belt, Man's, Waist, Blue 334 (Army Band Uniform)

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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